

Protecting the body...

A gladiator's shield was large and oblong, or small and round, depending on the weapon he carried.

... and the head

Headgear was made to be showy to impress people, as well as to provide good protection.

... Sharp spear

Some gladiators used long spears to jab at their opponents. The spears were wooden poles tipped with an iron point.

Quick quiz



How many types of gladiator were there?



Was a sica a spear or a sword?



What did gladiators wear on their feet?

Gladiators fought on sand.

... Mix and match

Gladiators often wore protective leg armor, but not everyone had the same armor or weapons. The crowds enjoyed seeing how the differences affected the fights.

No shoes!

Gladiators fought in bare feet or wore leather sandals with straps.